

WAIVED GOODBYE
Money, health issues push Cowboys to release Super Bowl quarterback Troy Aikman.
C5



BASEBALL
Belle, Orioles agree return to field is 'highly unlikely'
Page C3

NFL
Colts match Browns' offer, keep lineman Waverly Jackson
Page C5

HIGH SCHOOL FOOTBALL
Fred Churchill, longtime area coach, dead at 63
Obituaries, page B2

Sports

The Chronicle-Telegram Thursday, March 8, 2001 **C1**

Sinking to new depths

Cleveland blows late lead in loss to horrid Wizards

Rick Noland
The Chronicle-Telegram

CLEVELAND — It's official: At this moment, the Cavs are the worst team in the NBA.

Cleveland went above and beyond the call of duty to earn that distinction Wednesday night, falling 88-83 to the woeful Washington Wizards at Gund Arena.

The Cavs (22-38) have lost six straight, 18 of 20 and 31 of 38, leading to speculation that Randy Wittman's coaching career in Cleveland may be about to end.

Point guard Bimbo Coles, however, doesn't think Wittman is the problem.

"We're still plugging away," he said. "Some guys will drift a little and start looking toward the end of the season, but we're still playing basketball. It's just not good basketball."

Washington (14-47), which didn't

Sabathia won't rush stardom

Chris Assenheimer
The Chronicle-Telegram

TAMPA, Fla. — With their pitching staff ravaged by injuries, the Indians considered activating C.C. Sabathia late last season.

He's glad they didn't. "I think it was the best thing, me not pitching down the stretch," said the 20-year-old left-hander. "We were playing some big games and that would've been a lot of pressure. I'm glad they didn't just throw me in there. That showed they cared a lot about me."

The Indians care plenty about Sabathia, who has been earmarked for stardom since the Tribe made him its top choice in the 1998 draft. There aren't a whole lot of 6-foot-7, 265-pound lefty starters with 100 mph fastballs in the big leagues these days.

"This is a kid that is close," said Indians general manager John Hart. "There's not really many flaws in what you see. He still needs experience, and we'll keep running him out there to get it."

See SABATHIA, C6

HIGH SCHOOL BASKETBALL: THE TOURNAMENT TRAIL

Cats claw way to Elite 8



GRETCHEN THOMAS / CHRONICLE

PURPLE POWER: Keystone's Brandy Terry goes in for a layup Wednesday during the second quarter of the Wildcats' 36-27 regional semifinal victory over Findlay Liberty-Benton.

Defense leaves Keystone 1 win from Columbus

Bob Daniels
The Chronicle-Telegram

LEXINGTON — Less than a week ago, Keystone's girls advanced beyond the district tournament level for the first time and rewrote the school's basketball history book.

They rewrote it again Wednesday night. In a physical game in which defense saved their spotty-shooting hides from self-destruction, the Wildcats defeated previously once-beaten Findlay Liberty-Benton 36-27 in a Division III regional semifinal game at Lexington High School.

It puts them one victory away from a spot in the Division III Final Four next week in Columbus and ends the Eagles' season at 22-2.

"Our girls beat a good basketball team tonight," said Keystone coach Scott Terry. "You know, there's a lot of people who say the team that comes out of that Wellington district is usually pretty weak. One thing we wanted to do tonight was to come out here and play hard and represent our district and our county, and I think our girls did a good job of doing that."

The game was a nail-biter that had the crowd on its feet through much of the fourth quarter and wasn't really over until Erin Shaw sank two foul shots in the fleeting seconds to create the final score. Until she did, the Eagles — lurking within four points — kept firing up 3-point shots in an effort to catch up. They missed seven of eight in the fourth quarter.

When it was over, Keystone fans danced to the music of a boom box and celebrated playfully in the lobby outside the gymnasium.

The Wildcats (21-3) can advance to the Final Four with a regional championship victory over Hamlet Patrick Henry at 1:30 p.m. Saturday in

See 'CATS, C4

Gansey explodes as Falls takes next step

Tim Gebhardt
The Chronicle-Telegram

LORAIN — Just when Holy Name felt it could play with top-seeded Olmsted Falls in a Lorain Division II district semifinal Wednesday night, Mike Gansey and company proved otherwise.

The Bulldogs used a 14-point third-quarter run to chase Holy Name out of the tournament, 73-58, and advance to Saturday's final at 7 p.m. against tonight's Elyria Catholic-Avon Lake victor. Falls is 18-4. The Green Wave crashed at 9-15.

Olmsted Falls led 41-38 with just under five minutes to play in the third quarter after Holy Name scored on successive layups by Brendon Downs, Tom Harrington and Drew Kraemer. Falls coach Pat Donahue wisely called his first timeout of the evening to remind his

DIVISION II AT ADMIRAL KING

team just who was the top dog anyway. Gansey went right to work.

Two free throws, a bunny, a reverse layup off a missed Dan Terbeck free throw (he made the first), a stuff, another bunny and subsequent free throw — all courtesy of the 6-foot-5 superman. When Armando Flores finished the flurry with a tap-in, Falls was in its comfort zone, 55-38.

Gansey scored 11 of the Bulldogs' 14, and in a period of about four minutes, Holy Name was no longer in the game.

"I was in the right place at the right time," Gansey said. "I got a couple buckets. Everyone stepped up."

"What surprised me about it was the way

See FALLS, C5



LINDA MURPHY / CHRONICLE

UP, UNDER AND IN: Olmsted Falls' Mike Gansey hits a reverse layup against Holy Name's Greg DiMarino (right) Wednesday during the Bulldogs' 73-58 Division II district semifinal win.

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